

KF Tapping Protocol¹

1. Determine the focus

What is the problem or issue that you want to address? You might consider one of the fears that you noticed this week. Your problem would be whatever triggered the fear. Begin with the phrase ***“My problem is that . . .”*** and then state the problem in simple terms.

Sometimes we imagine that fear is our problem, so we get confused and want to start our statement with *“My problem is that I feel fear . . .”* Instead, try to identify the event that triggered the fear. When did you start feeling the fear? What happened that caused a spike of anxiety? It’s important to recognize when we feel the fear. We learn to do this through mindfulness training.

2. Identify your emotions

What do you feel when you think about your problem? (*Pause*) Add to your healing statement ***“and when I think of that, I feel . . .”*** Now list a few of the emotions that you have identified.

You might find it helpful to refer to the lists of emotions on the KF worksheets.

3. Write down your healing statement

Your healing statement is now complete. Here is an example: *My problem is that I am experiencing a life change, and when I think of that, I feel lonely, distressed, anxious, and vulnerable.* Be sure to write down your healing statement and keep it in a place where you can easily find it again for your KF work.

If this healing statement doesn’t feel comfortable for you, try beginning your statement with the words ***“I am releasing the . . .”*** Now state whatever fear, trauma, anxiety, or craving need you might be experiencing. Our example might then be: *I am releasing the anxiety of facing a life change.* A preliminary tap using this simpler format might help clear your mind so that you can construct a more comprehensive healing statement for a second tap.

Here are the two models again:

- ***My problem is [state the problem], and when I think of that, I feel [list your feeling(s)].***
- ***I am releasing the [trauma of, feeling of, need to, fear of, etc.].***

Remember that the intention to heal is more powerful than the exact wording.

4. Assess the level of fear or stress

On a scale of one to ten, with ten being the most stressful for you, how stressful is your problem? Make a note of that.

First Series

Sip some purified water and assume a mindfulness posture. Be sure to breathe deeply while you tap. You might want to make noise with your breathing to help you focus.

Opening

With the palm of each hand, rub your chest in a circular motion, crossing your palms over the sternum. While rubbing, breathe deeply and repeat this statement after me:

I fully and completely accept myself as I am today. (Read 3 times, pausing for 3 seconds after each reading)

Remember to breathe deeply as you tap.

- *Using the three middle fingers of each hand, tap gently on the orbital bones under your eyes. (Repeat) Read your healing statement out loud and then breathe deeply as you tap: “**My problem is . . . , and when I think of that, I feel . . .**” (Tap for 20 seconds)*
- Now, under your dominant arm, which is most often the right arm, find a point about four inches below the armpit. Massage this rather tender spot as you repeat your healing statement. Try not to worry about finding the exact location. *(Tap for 20 seconds)*
- Pause. With the palm of each hand facing you, push your little fingers away from you and bring your two ring fingers together so that they touch each other. *Bring all the middle fingers together to form a kind of picket fence and tap on your brow, above your nose, with all six fingertips.* Breathe, and repeat your statement. *(Tap for 20 seconds)*
- Locate your collarbone and follow it out to your shoulder joints. Drop down about two inches into the crevice between your shoulders and chest muscles. Massage these two points and repeat your statement. You might find it easier to cross your arms over your chest while you do this. Breathe. *(Tap for 20 seconds)*
- Now, follow your collarbone back to the sternum. Drop down about two inches on each side of the sternum and tap or massage the space between your ribs. Repeat your statement and breathe. *(Tap for 20 seconds)*
- Move to the little finger of your left hand. *With the three middle fingers of your right hand, tap on the inside edge of the left little finger, incorporating the edge of the fingernail. (Repeat)* Repeat your statement and breathe. *(Tap for 20 seconds)*
- Pause. Take a deep breath and sip some water. On a scale of one to ten, how distressing is the problem or trigger event now? Jot down the number for your reference.

Second Series

Remember to breathe deeply as you tap.

- Say your healing statement out loud.
- Now, *using the three middle fingers of your right hand, gently tap on the back of your left hand between the tendons of your little finger and your ring finger. (Repeat)* While you are tapping, breathe deeply and say your healing statement out loud one more time. *(Tap for 10 seconds)*

We are now going to do an eye movement exercise. Keep your head still and only move your eyes. Breathe deeply and continue to tap the back of your hand while you follow these directions:

- Focus your eyes straight ahead.
- Now close your eyes while you continue to tap and breathe.
- Open your eyes again and, without moving your head, look sharply down toward your right hip or elbow for a few seconds.
- Now look sharply down toward your left side, again without moving your head.
- Repeat this right and left eye movement two more times while you tap and breathe.
- Now roll your eyes in a circle, three times in one direction and then three times in the opposite direction. You might look to one side and then direct your eyes up the wall to the ceiling, across the ceiling, down the opposite wall, and across the floor.
- Continue to tap while you hum the tune “Happy Birthday” or “Row, Row, Row Your Boat”.
- Now quickly count out loud to fifteen.
- Hum the tune again while you continue to tap.

Pause. Take a sip of purified water and relax. After the meeting, you can finish up your tap by repeating the first series. Then pat gently on the crown of your head for about 5 seconds and then tap over your heart to complete the tap.

¹ Dr. Roger Callahan, “TFT Stress Buster Tapping Class-Learn to Use TFT Tapping,” Callahan Techniques, accessed April 24, 2016, www.rogercallahan.com/learn-to-tap.php. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.